2023-24

THE PROJECT SUICIDE

PHASE - III REPORT

(TPS AMBASSADORSHIP PROGRAM-I)

A journey of 8 months with 60 Pakistani Universities. Bridging the gaps, Surpassing the Barriers & Connecting Pakistan for Better Mental Health.

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Foreword

Mental health remains one of the most pressing yet overlooked challenges of our time, particularly in Pakistan, where stigma and limited resources continue to hinder progress. Recognizing the urgent need for action, The Project Suicide (TPS) was founded with a singular vision: to challenge the status quo, foster open conversations, and build sustainable, community-driven solutions to mental health crises. Over the past two years, TPS has evolved from a student-led initiative into a nationwide movement, empowering young leaders to be at the forefront of change.

The TPS Ambassadorship Program (AP) represents a milestone in this journey. Conceived as an ambitious strategy to engage university students in mental health advocacy, the program sought to dismantle societal barriers and promote help-seeking behaviors. Through rigorous training, innovative project execution, and collaborative leadership, AP Cycle I has cultivated a generation of youth who are not only equipped with essential skills but are actively reshaping the mental health landscape of Pakistan.

This report serves as a testament to their dedication, resilience, and impact. It outlines the meticulous planning, strategic recruitment, and intensive training that laid the foundation for AP Cycle I, followed by the execution of grassroots initiatives across the country. Most importantly, it reflects on the lessons learned and the pathways forward as we prepare to scale this initiative further in cycle II.

The success of AP Cycle I is a testament to the power of collective action. As we look ahead, we remain committed to expanding this movement, strengthening our networks, and ensuring that no voice goes unheard. Mental health is not just a personal struggle; it is a societal responsibility. Through sustained efforts and unwavering determination, we will continue to build a future where seeking support is a norm, not an exception.

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Introduction

Recognizing the alarming and distressing state of mental health and suicide in Pakistan, particularly the deep-rooted stigma experienced personally by friends, family, and the local community around, an initiative was thought out in the form of The Project Suicide.

The Project Suicide was established on June 25, 2022, with the mission to reduce, if not entirely eliminate, the obstacles hindering mental health awareness and support. The Project Suicide (TPS) is working as an independent non-profit organization dedicated to addressing suicide and mental health challenges in Pakistan. It focuses on raising awareness, preventing suicide, conducting research, and offering vital psychoeducation to foster a culture of seeking help and saving lives.

In this report is highlighted details of the newest, novel endeavor of TPS, The Ambassadorship Program. Chapter 1 reports the postulation of this program from an abstract idea, while Chapter 5 deals with its meticulous execution. Subsequently, chapter 6 concludes this with the evaluation, highlighting the tangible impact made across Pakistan in the domain of mental health and suicide.

The information detailed are summarized from small projects executed across numerous universities of Pakistan, which gives a glimpse into the landscape of mental health of the country in 2024, and accordingly what necessary impacts and projections are needed for a future, bolder endeavor.

Key Messages

The TPS Ambassadorship Program has demonstrated the power of youth-led initiatives in transforming the mental health landscape of Pakistan. By equipping university students with critical skills in project management, leadership, and psychoeducation, the program has empowered them to challenge stigma, promote help-seeking behaviors, and create sustainable mental health interventions within their communities. Through structured training and hands-on execution, ambassadors have not only raised awareness but also provided tangible support mechanisms, reinforcing the need for localized, culturally relevant mental health solutions.

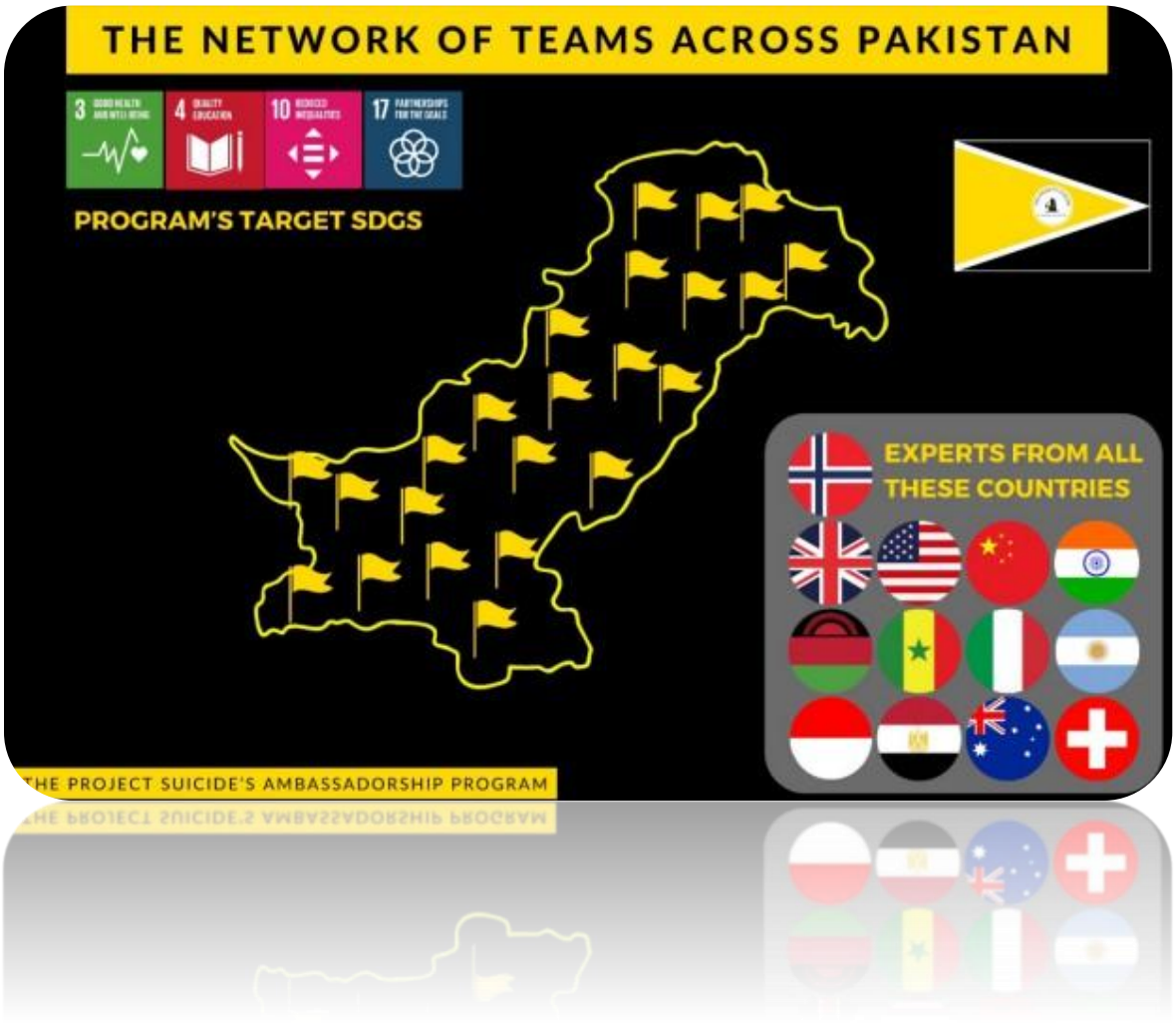
This report highlights the strategic planning, rigorous training, and impactful projects executed across Pakistan under AP Cycle I. It underscores the importance of youth engagement in addressing mental health challenges, proving that when given the right resources and mentorship, young leaders can drive meaningful change. Moving forward, it is essential to invest in such initiatives, scale their reach, and integrate mental health advocacy into broader public health and education frameworks to ensure long-term, systemic impact.

01. Conceptualizing The Ambassadorship Program

1.1. The Ambassadorship Program

The Ambassadorship Program by The Project Suicide (TPS) was an initiative designed to create a network of student-led teams i.e., Ambassadors across universities in Pakistan. The program aimed to maximize reach and impact by establishing teams in different regions of the country, allowing for personalized approaches to mental health awareness and support based on local needs and challenges.

By training and empowering these teams, TPS effectively expanded its influence, provided psychoeducation, and combated stigma within various communities. This decentralized model was designed to enable TPS to reach a larger audience more efficiently and sustainably, addressing the urgent need for accessible mental health resources and support throughout Pakistan.



1.1.1. A Crucial Need

Pakistan's society grapples with a significant mental health crisis and alarming suicide rates, combined with a pervasive stigma surrounding mental health issues and suicide. This stigma originates from societal apprehension of scrutiny, deeply ingrained religious constraints, and entrenched cultural standards. Consequently, individuals are discouraged from seeking assistance, exacerbating the problems related to mental health and suicide. Even professionals are hesitant to report cases of attempts or provide help.

Furthermore, there exists an absence of accessibility to mental health services and a lack of fundamental education on identifying suicidal tendencies and providing aid to those in crisis. Many individuals remain oblivious to the existence of available resources, such as suicide hotlines and safety measures, thereby intensifying the issue.

Additionally, a systemic dearth of leadership in mental health advocacy impedes sustainable transformation and meaningful influence. The situation is alarming as an estimated 53 lives are lost to suicide each day, over 1200 suicide attempts, and approximately 50 million individuals in dire need of psychological and professional assistance, of whom only a mere 10% receive adequate support. Therefore, urgent action is necessary to combat stigma, encourage assistance-seeking behavior, and enhance accessibility to mental health services and so the Ambassadorship Program emerges as an indispensable intervention to spur positive change and nurture a climate of mental well-being in Pakistan.

1.1.2. The Vision

The Ambassadorship Program by The Project Suicide (TPS) was conceived out of a pressing need to effectively reach the diverse landscape of Pakistan. Relying on one centralized team to tackle the mental health challenges across the country was neither efficient nor effective in terms of time and resources. It became clear that a network of personalized teams, comprising Lead and General Ambassadors across various universities was necessary to tailor efforts according to the unique cultural and social contexts of each region.

By distributing the work to ambassador teams from various cities, whether in the north or south of Pakistan, TPS were able to more effectively address the specific challenges and needs of different communities. This decentralized approach allowed TPS to harness local insights and engage with community members in a more meaningful way. Ambassadors, being from the same cultural and social backgrounds, could communicate the importance of mental health awareness and suicide prevention in a manner that resonated with their peers. This strategy not only optimized resource allocation but also ensured that mental health initiatives were contextually relevant and impactful

1.1.3. Why University Students?

The reason TPS decided to call ambassadors from universities all over Pakistan is that research indicates universities are hotspots for high levels of suicidal ideation and behavior. Academic pressure, parental expectations, the fear of securing jobs after graduation, and relationship issues are some of the primary factors contributing to the decline in students' mental health. Consequently, students often struggle to focus on their studies and perform effectively, exacerbating their mental health problems.

Additionally, a large number of university students fall into the 18+ age category. Recognizing the sensitivity of the topic of suicide and the level of maturity required to

address it, TPS specifically designed the Ambassadorship Program for university students rather than college and school students. This approach ensured that the program participants had the necessary maturity and understanding to effectively engage with the serious and complex issues surrounding mental health and suicide prevention.

Therefore, university students, more than any other demographic, needed guidance on how to recognize, accept, and manage their mental health issues to prevent drastic actions. Given their educational background, they held the potential to become advocates for mental health awareness, spreading the message across all sections of society and amplifying the importance of mental health support.

1.1.4. Personalized Team For Effective Outreach

Creating a network of student-led teams allowed for a more personalized approach in each locality. These teams, comprised of students from various academic backgrounds, could address issues and raise awareness in ways that resonated with their own communities. While most students did not have professional backgrounds in psychology or mental health, they received training through online sessions that equipped them with the fundamental knowledge and skills to conduct mental health awareness activities and help destigmatize seeking support. These training sessions also helped ambassadors develop essential leadership skills for conducting mental health activities in their respective universities and understanding the factors leading to mental health problems and suicide. They were trained to identify warning signs in individuals with suicidal ideations and refer them to emergency helplines or TPS, where they can be connected to professional psychologists.

This localized approach would enable the teams to engage with their peers and community members in a more relatable and accessible manner. By leveraging their understanding of the cultural and social context, they can effectively challenge misconceptions, encourage open conversations about mental health with empathy and sensitivity, and promote proactive help-seeking behavior.

1.1.5. Local HopeSellers For Change

One of the most significant advantages of the Ambassadorship Program is that the individuals spreading awareness and providing support are from the very communities they aim to serve. This local perspective is crucial in breaking down barriers of cultural and societal resistance. By being from the same locality, these student leaders were able to connect with individuals on a personal level. These Ambassadors can communicate more effectively with local communities, helping them understand the critical state of mental health issues and the alarming rise in suicide rates in Pakistan in their native languages. This localized approach ensured that the message of mental health awareness and suicide prevention resonate deeply and is accessible to a broader audience and this personal connection and community-based approach play a pivotal role in breaking down long-standing barriers and promoting mental well-being at the grassroots level.

Conclusively, Ambassadorship Program by The Project Suicide (TPS) served as an essential catalyst for a great change across Pakistan. By empowering local student-led teams (Ambassadors), the program effectively addresses mental health challenges with sensitivity and cultural awareness. These ambassadors were expected to play a critical role in fostering trust within their communities,

promoting open conversations about mental health, and guiding individuals toward seeking support. This grassroots approach to breaking down stigmas and enhancing accessibility to mental health resources would pave the way for a more resilient and compassionate society. Through this program, TPS ensured to make a meaningful and lasting impact on the mental well-being of the nation.

1.2. Theory of Change

In conceptualizing the Ambassadorship Program, the team drew upon a robust framework known as the **Theory of Change**. The theory provided a structured and strategic roadmap for addressing mental health challenges within Pakistan. Ultimately, with a broader purpose of leading to meaningful and sustainable outcomes for individuals and communities across Pakistan, the theory of change was a blueprint for it.

Here are the key components of Ambassadorship Program within the Theory of Change framework:

Comprehensive Training

Equipping the ambassadors with the necessary skills.

The program was designed to provide ambassadors with thorough training in various areas, including psychoeducation, psychological first aid, project management, and leadership. This training was to equip them with the necessary knowledge and skills to effectively address mental health challenges within their communities.

Small Scale Projects

Practical application of the learned skills in the field.

The Ambassadors were to be tasked with implementing small-scale projects within their university communities. These projects were carefully designed to raise awareness about mental health, combat stigma, and provide essential resources to those in need. By focusing on localized initiatives, the program aimed to create meaningful impacts at the grassroots level.

Measurable Outcomes

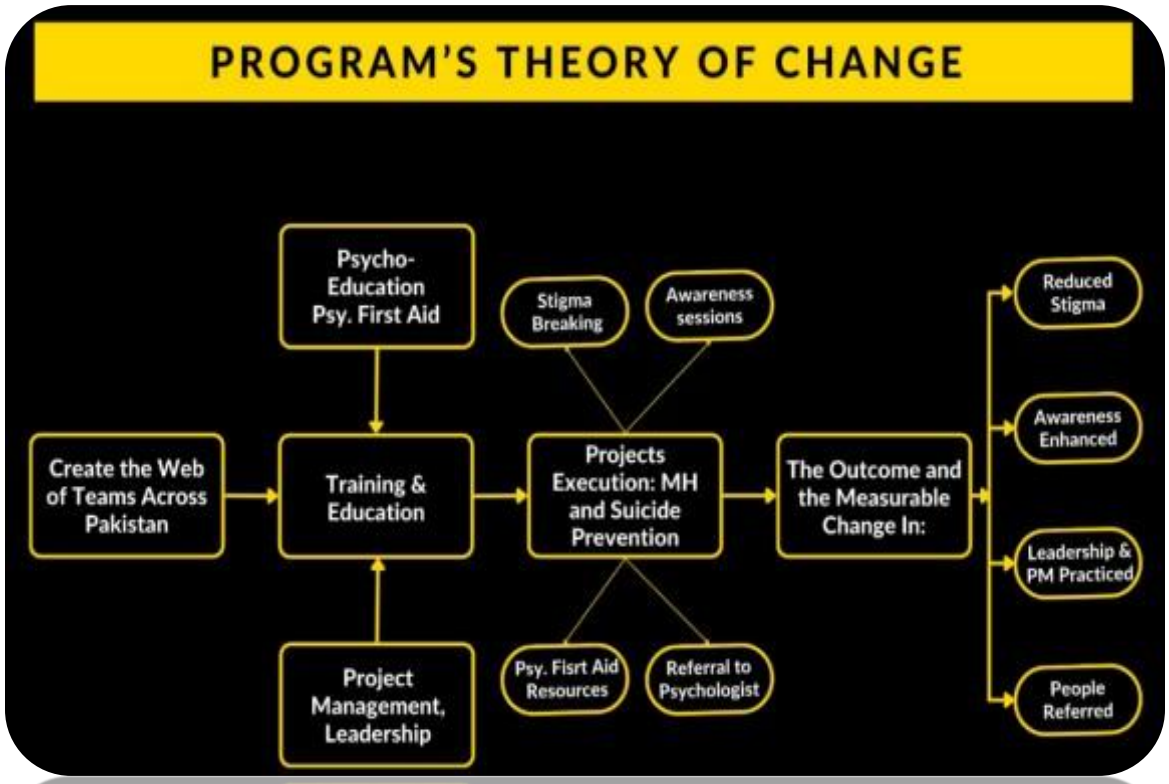
Quantitative evaluation of the efforts put.

The program set clear and measurable outcomes to track its effectiveness. These outcomes include quantifiable reductions in the stigma associated with mental health, as well as the practical application and enhancement of project management and leadership skills among participants. By measuring these outcomes, the program can assess its progress and adjust strategies as needed.

Long Term Impact

Think Global Act Local

Ultimately, the program aimed to achieve long-term impact by contributing to lower suicide rates heightened awareness about mental health issues, and the creation of supportive environments for those in need. By addressing mental health challenges at the grassroots level and empowering individuals to take action in their own respective localities, the program endeavored to catalyze positive change throughout Pakistani society and ultimately bring about change at the global level.



1.3. Objectives & Deliverables

The objectives and deliverables of the TPS Ambassadorship Program (TPS-AP) were aligned with the pressing challenges currently faced and the theory of change for TPS-AP. To systematically address these issues in the short and long term, TPS-AP aimed to achieve the following objectives over the next six months.

01

Objective

To recruit students from universities across Pakistan and create a network of emerging leaders by creating teams in each university and connecting them via online platforms for interactions and working with other teams.

Deliverable

By announcing volunteer job positions over social media platforms and sending them manually to different universities where mental health advocacy is imperative and receiving applications from them.

02

Objective

To equip those students with essential skills required for working on mental health and suicide prevention in Pakistan.

Deliverable

By training them in project management, leadership, sustainability, and psychoeducation by inviting experts from 13 countries across the globe.

03

Objective

To develop and execute small-scale projects inside their campuses and work on stigma breaking, referral to professionals, awareness, resource provision, and practicing the learned skills.

Deliverable

By brainstorming and executing them before, during, and after the training sessions and developing those projects with the help of Team Leads by TPS to each university and templates for planning the projects provided by TPS.

04

Objective

To provide a platform for students, promote intercultural interactions and broaden students' worldviews to enhance peace and cultural tolerance among youth.

Deliverable

By providing them an online platform via online meetings and discussions with students from across Pakistan and experts from the globe. Further, via every two weeks meetings with their fellow universities and team.

05

Objective

To build sustainable capacity in the domain of mental health and contribute to the knowledge economy of Pakistan.

Deliverable

By fostering skills development among students for sustainable project management and leadership, in mental health advocacy and suicide

06

Objective

To promote mental health sustainability on national level and encourage students for further action in future.

Deliverable

By organizing one of the biggest mental health sustainability gathering in Islamabad Pakistan. Invite all the ambassadors from across Pakistan to participate and to distribute their shields, certifications, and awards for best performance during the entire program.

1.4. Program Timeline

The program's timeline delineated its chronological progression, from planning and recruitment to implementation and evaluation. The timeline of the Ambassadorship Program by The Project Suicide (TPS) was a six-month plan consisting of two primary phases: the pre-implementation phase and the implementation phase.

Dec 2023

Pre-Implementation Phase

This phase of the program, although not completely theoretical, involved facets of the planning of the ambassadorship program too. To prepare the program thereby for right and effective execution, there needed several preparations to be made in regard to external and internal team building, and introduction of those teams to the Ambassadorship Program.

Conceptualizing the Ambassadorship Program

Although mentioned in particular detail in the section above, this phase erecting a theoretical framework of the whole program, and documentation of it, including building the timeline and drawing out the meticulous objectives.

Orientation of Team Lead and Lead Ambassadors

20th Jan 2024 marked the first orientation session of the program. During this session, TPS and AP were introduced to both the Team Leads and Lead Ambassadors and their respective roles were defined. Lastly, the Lead Ambassadors were tasked with forming a team of 10 General Ambassadors from their universities and reporting to their Team Leads.

Recruitment of Lead Ambassadors and Team Leads

Through a nationwide social media recruitment campaign, 56 Lead Ambassadors were interviewed and selected from various universities across Pakistan. As for the Team Leads, the existing pool of TPS volunteers was evaluated, ultimately selecting 9 candidates for the program after a rigorous interview process.

Team Building by the Lead Ambassadors

Guided by the Team Leads, and the document which had the criteria of what kind of students to recruit from their respective universities, the Lead Ambassadors were instructed to start a campaign in their campus for such recruitment. By the end of it, a team of 10 students were created that acted as General Ambassadors for the whole program.

Feb 2024

Implementation Phase

The implementation phase of the program consisted of two parts: training sessions on various topics such as psychoeducation, SDGs, project management, leadership, and teamwork, followed by the application of these learned skills in executing on-ground activities.

Grand Orientation of The Program

On 3rd Feb 2024, teams of 10 Ambassadors from 56 universities attended the grand orientation session. The history of TPS, the program's hierarchy, and the timeline were presented. Ambassadors were introduced to their team leads and briefed on the importance of the Program and the actions expected of them in the coming months.

APRIL 2024

On-Ground Mental Health & Suicide Awareness Activities

The activity execution on ground began, where various activities from chit-distribution to seminars on mental health and suicide awareness were conducted in their campuses. The data was reported in words as well as documented on frame, which was daily updated on our social media pages. Each activity was first approved by the evaluation team, before it could be executed.

Additional Training Sessions

Four additional sessions covered training on SDGs, leadership, teamwork, and basic project management techniques. Ambassadors were taught brainstorming skills, how to write activity proposals, and how to use provided templates. They learned to complete and submit activity proposals and evaluation reports, which they were required to fill out after each activity.

Training on Psychoeducation

Over the next 2 months, four virtual sessions were held with the ambassadors to discuss the three main facets of psychoeducation: the problem of suicide, identification, and prevention. These sessions included activities such as debates, role-playing, and potential field scenarios.

June 2024

Rigorous Training on Project Management by PMI Switzerland

The help from the Project Management Institute could only be availed during the closing end of the program. For this, 3 sessions were conducted in the month of June with the team from PMI Switzerland, who gave very detailed clarifications on project management, conducted several tests for our ambassadors to test their knowledge and provided several tools to help with project management and planning.

Closing Ceremony of the Internal Team

To laud the efforts of the internal team, which included associates, team leads, and social media team, a gathering was organized in COMSATS university, Islamabad on 29th July 2024. During the ceremony, shields and certificates were distributed, and the teams given some snippets on the scaling of the ambassadorship program for the next phase to motivate them for future work.

July 2024

Program Closing

Once the execution of the activities ceased, the last phase of the program began, the wrapping up of the Ambassadorship Program. This involved a thorough analysis of the ambassadors and Team Leads performance evaluation, compiling and evaluating the quantitative data retrieved from the evaluations reports of the many activities executed. From all of this, there were also calculated the best performing universities and team leads.

Documentation Evaluation & Final Reporting

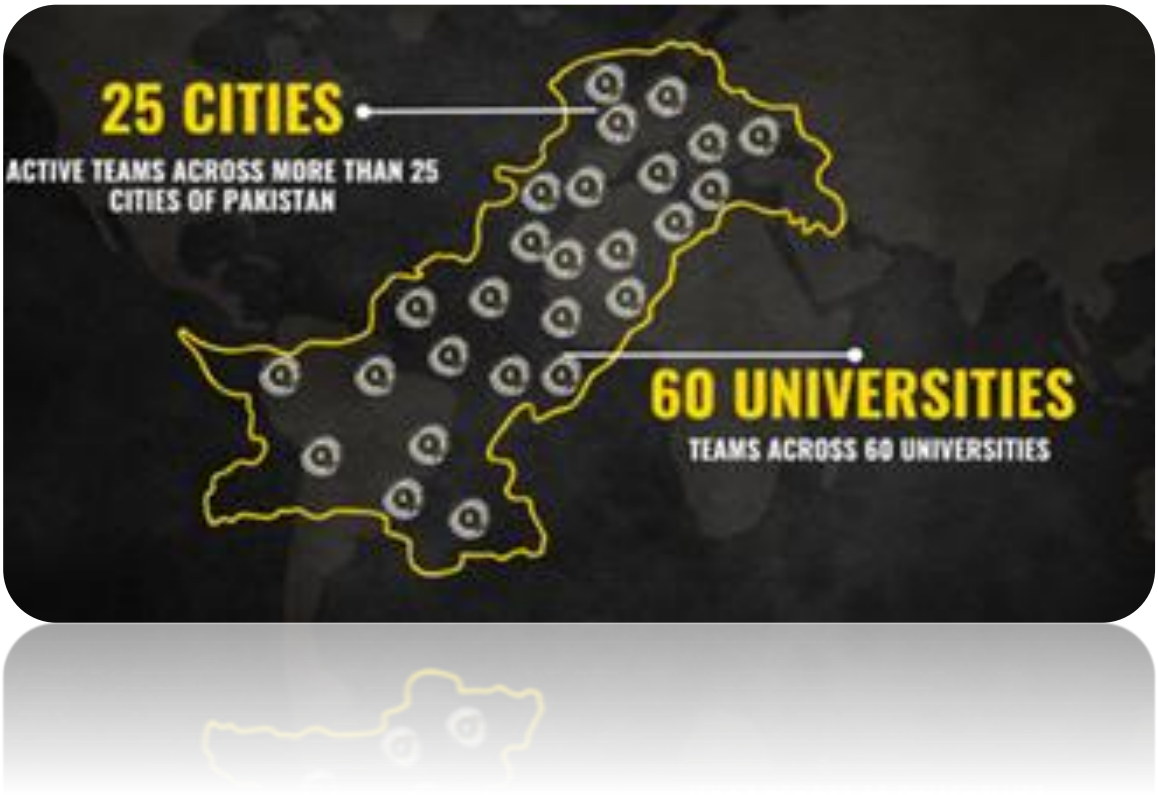
Once the execution of the activities ceased, the documentation phase followed in which the ambassadors were instructed to fill in the templates for evaluation report of each and every one of the activities that they had conducted, reporting how many people they directly, indirectly impacted, how many people refereed to psychologist, how many stigmas broken and how many lives saved. Subsequently, these were compiled and documented by the evaluations team. While the team leads were instructed to give the best performing ambassadors, who were to be considered for promotion in the next program.

02. Recruitment

2.1. Recruitment Overview

After finalizing the planning phase and establishing the objectives and deliverables of the Ambassadorship Program, the next step involved initiating the recruitment process. Recognizing the importance of assembling a dedicated and passionate team, recruitment efforts commenced promptly following the formulation of the program's framework.

Through targeted outreach and engagement strategies, we sought to attract university students across Pakistan who demonstrated a commitment to mental health advocacy and a willingness to participate in the program's initiatives. With the groundwork laid and objectives set, the recruitment phase marked the transition from planning to action, signifying the beginning of a journey towards positive change and mental health empowerment. The recruitment process for the Ambassadorship Program involved a systematic approach to assemble a dedicated team of university students across Pakistan. The process was structured in a hierarchical manner, starting with the core team, and progressing down to the general ambassadors.



2.1.1. Core Team

The core team was responsible for overseeing the entire recruitment process, ensuring that it was carried out efficiently and aligned with the program's objectives and goals. They identified and appointed Team Leads from the pool of experienced and reliable old volunteers who had previously worked with TPS.

2.1.2. Team Leads

The core team conducted thorough interviews with the team leads to ensure they were well-qualified and aligned with the program's mission and values. Once selected, team leads were assigned to different universities, and their respective lead ambassadors were recruited across the country.

2.1.3. Lead Ambassadors

Lead ambassadors were recruited through online Google forms through targeted outreach and engagement strategies that were circulated among the audience of the targeted universities. The core team reviewed the forms filled in by the candidates for the role of lead ambassadors to assess their suitability for the role and their ability to lead and manage a team effectively. Upon selection, lead ambassadors were provided with comprehensive guidelines for recruiting and managing their teams in their respective universities to achieve optimal teamwork and results.

2.1.4. General Ambassadors

Each Lead Ambassador was responsible for recruiting 9 General Ambassadors from their respective universities. Supervised by the Team Leads, they had the flexibility to choose the willingness to participate in the program's initiatives. To ensure cohesive and effective teams, Team Leads were allowed to replace any general ambassador who was not meeting expectations or causing issues. However, they had to provide concrete evidence to support their decision to replace a team member with the core team and needed approvals for it.

2.1.5. Execution of The Ambassadorship Program

The Ambassadorship Program, the third phase of The Project Suicide, aimed to empower university students to become advocates for mental health awareness and suicide prevention. This aim was achieved through a set of objectives and deliverables that aligned with addressing pressing challenges in Mental Health Awareness and Suicide Prevention in Pakistan. The objectives of the TPS Ambassadorship Program encompassed recruiting and training university students from all over Pakistan, facilitating the development and execution of small-scale mental health projects, promoting intercultural interactions, building sustainable capacity in mental health advocacy, and organizing a national level gathering to promote mental health sustainability.

Creating a network of emerging leaders was the first step toward the achievement of this goal. For this purpose, a total of 56 Lead Ambassadors were recruited to oversee projects taking place at the universities which were under their supervision. Moreover, Team Leads were recruited and tasked with supervising a group of 6-8 Lead Ambassadors.

most suitable candidates based on their commitment to mental health advocacy and

2.2. Criteria of Recruitment

2.2.1. Team Leads

Candidates were selected as Team Leads from the pool of TPS's volunteers, associated with The Project Suicide for a long time, after extensive interviews in which they were assessed for their motivation, creativity, leadership abilities, time management, communication skills, and conflict management skills through different kinds of scenario-based questions. The interviews were structured to provide candidates with the opportunity to demonstrate their capabilities and suitability for the role of Team Lead. Each interview session comprised a series of questions designed to produce a response that might shed light on the candidate's leadership style, experience in mentorship and guidance, and ability to navigate challenges effectively. Additionally, candidates were presented with hypothetical scenarios relevant to the responsibilities of a Team Lead within the Ambassadorship Program.

Questions Asked During the Interview Process

1. What to do if the lead ambassador is not responding to your texts?
2. In case permission is not being granted to the Lead Ambassador for conducting activities during their university premise, how would you handle this situation?
3. What happens when the Lead Ambassadors come to you with complaints that some of the General Ambassadors in their team are not cooperating with them, how would you guide them, and how would you handle this situation?
4. How would you ensure that all your Lead and General Ambassadors are kept motivated throughout the six-month tenure?
5. In case of conflicts between Lead Ambassadors and General Ambassadors, how will you handle it?
6. As Team Lead, how would you ensure your honesty and commitment towards The Project Suicide in these 6 months of The Ambassadorship Program?
7. Given that the Ambassadorship program is online, how do you plan to sustain the motivation of Lead Ambassadors under your supervision? What strategies do you believe will maintain their morale and motivation throughout the program?

These scenarios allowed candidates to showcase their problem-solving skills, adaptability, and strategic thinking in addressing potential challenges that may arise in managing their assigned Universities and Ambassadors as well as the commitment of Team Leads toward the cause of promoting Mental Health Awareness and Suicide Prevention in Pakistan.

Candidates were Evaluated Against Preset Selection Criteria

1. Demonstrated leadership abilities.
2. Strong verbal communication skills, particularly in their native language. Additionally, emphasis was placed on their ability to effectively communicate using simple language, especially when interacting with students in regions facing educational challenges.
3. A passion for mental health and suicide prevention and generally helping other human beings with the motive of serving humanity.
4. Candidates were evaluated based on their capability to work independently and handle multiple tasks concurrently. Given that each Team Lead would oversee multiple universities, their aptitude in managing such responsibilities was closely assessed.
5. Adaptability and resilience in navigating complex and dynamic environments. The strong will of the Team Leads to handle complicated situations with patience and perseverance.
6. Problem-solving capabilities in case of conflicts or in scenarios where the Core Team is not available at that very moment, how will the Team Lead handle that situation on his own?

Both Team Leads and Lead Ambassadors were selected based on a comprehensive set of criteria designed to identify individuals with a strong commitment to mental health advocacy, Leadership potential, and Project Management capabilities. Through this interview process, TPS sought to identify individuals who demonstrated a deep understanding of the issues at hand, coupled with innovative ideas and a genuine desire to bring positive change. Ultimately, 9 Team leads, who stood out as exemplary candidates with a strong desire to serve in the motto and cause of The Project Suicide, were recruited into the Ambassadorship Program.

2.2.2. Team Leads

The recruitment process began with targeted advertising across university campuses, followed by an application and screening phase. Purposive sampling and snowball sampling were used for advertisements and the candidates who applied for the Ambassadorship Program were encouraged to spread the message on their social media platforms. For this purpose, personalized posters were created featuring their names- encouraging their friends and followers to join the cause.

Out of a pool of 159 candidates who applied for the Ambassadorship Program, 125 individuals were initially shortlisted based on their responses to two key questions:

1. ***Personal Motivation behind joining TPS.***
2. ***Innovative ideas for spreading awareness on Mental Health issues.***

These shortlisted candidates were further screened, with a particular focus on the depth of their motivation and the creativity of the awareness activities they proposed. After careful consideration, a total of 56 candidates from 56 different universities from all across Pakistan were selected as Lead Ambassadors. These Lead Ambassadors were selected from different universities all over Pakistan, ensuring inclusivity and representation from different disciplines and backgrounds.

2.2.3. Team Building by the Lead Ambassadors

After the selection of Lead Ambassadors, they were assigned the first task of building a team of passionate General Ambassadors in 20 days in their respective universities. The task was assigned on 11th January 2024 and the deadline for completing it was 1st Feb 2024. This task was of great importance to the success of our collective mission, serving as a cornerstone in our aim of conducting mental health awareness and suicide prevention activities and the leadership abilities of our Lead Ambassadors were to play a pivotal role in guiding this course of mental health advocacy alongside their General Ambassadors in their respective universities. Therefore, the Lead Ambassadors were provided with specific guidelines to ensure the fair selection of the General Ambassadors for their teams.

The following are the guidelines that were provided to the Lead Ambassadors.

01

Focus On Passion & Empathy

Look for individuals genuinely interested in mental health advocacy, who demonstrate empathy towards others and share the passion of serving humanity.

02

Prioritize Diverse Skills

Ensure gender diversity and aim for a team with a diverse set of skills like writing, photography, event planning, and digital editing. As the team consists of a total of 10 members, try to recruit 5 male and 5 female members to ensure diversity and equality in a team.

03

Utilize Online Platforms & University Networks

Leverage social media, student organizations, and mental health-related groups to find potential team members. Spread the message of recruitment in your friend circles and class groups via online platforms such as WhatsApp, Instagram, etc.

04

Competency Over Familiarity

Prioritize skills and dedication over personal connections when choosing team members. Avoid recruiting team members based on mere friendships and relations. This approach will lead of the creation of a team that shares the same passion and enthusiasm towards our goal.

05

Collect Essential Information

Gather full name, ID number, contact details, academic information, email address and a recent photo from each team member. Organize this in a document format and send it to your Team Lead. The timely collection of this data will streamline communication, facilitate coordination, and contribute to efficient functioning of team.

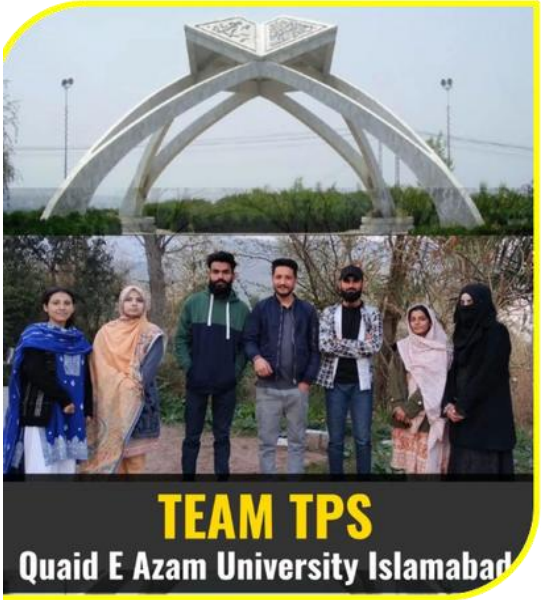
06

Commitment

Emphasize the program's duration (until July) to ensure team member dedication. Make sure you as Lead Ambassador and your team as General Ambassadors commit to work with honesty and hard work during these 6 months of the Ambassadorship Program. This will ensure the success of the program and contribute to the completion of its objectives.

2.2.4. Team Building by the Lead Ambassadors

The Lead Ambassadors built a team of 10 people based on the above guidelines. Given the high volume of applicants from certain universities, such as COMSATS, team members for these universities were primarily selected based on their abilities and enthusiasm from the pool of candidates who applied for the Ambassadorship Program.



Once the team was in place, Lead Ambassadors were encouraged to meet their General Ambassadors in person to foster a relationship built on mutual respect and a shared commitment to mental health awareness and suicide prevention. As advised, Lead Ambassadors hold meetings with their General Ambassadors to brainstorm ideas for activities to be conducted in the upcoming venture of six months. They also discussed the local suicide statistics and aspects, which served as a powerful motivator, inspiring them to work with dedication and integrity towards the cause.

03. Guiding Lead Ambassadors & Team Building

3.1. Ambassadors Orientation Session

Following the final selection of the 9 Team Leads and 56 Lead Ambassadors, two orientation sessions were conducted to equip them for their roles in promoting mental health awareness and Suicide Prevention in their respective university campuses. These sessions served as an opportunity for Ambassadors to connect with each other, share their motivations for joining The Project Suicide, clearing their confusion regarding Ambassadorship program and their roles in it as well as to cultivate a sense of community and belonging. Additionally, the Core Team familiarized Ambassadors with the program's objectives, hierarchy, expectations, goals and incentives.

3.1.1. Agenda Items for Discussion.

The first orientation session took place on 20th January,2024 for the Lead Ambassadors focused on program introduction, communication strategies, and team building and served as a platform for introductions and familiarization with Project Suicide's Ambassadorship Program goals. Most importantly, it provided Ambassadors with a framework for building effective teams, emphasizing the importance of diverse skill sets and passion for mental health advocacy.

The following are given some of the topics discussed during the orientations:

I. Introduction to The Project Suicide

All the Lead Ambassadors and General Ambassadors were introduced to TPS, its vision, mission, philosophy and its journey till now. Additionally, the Ambassadorship Program was explained and the agenda behind launching it in Phase III was also emphasized.

II. Introduction of Core Team

Moreover, the Core Team was introduced. Sheraz Akbar as Project Lead, Ilyas Ghafoor as Project Evaluator, Zeeshan Ahmed as

Communications Director and Zakaria Insaf as Operations Director.

III. Introduction of Team Leads and their respective universities

Each Team Lead was called out by Zakaria Insaf, and they introduced themselves. Lastly, Team Leads called out the name of universities under their jurisdiction ensuring that Lead Ambassadors were acquainted with their respective Team Leads.

IV. Team Building and Team requirements

Following their selection, each Lead Ambassador was tasked with forming a team of General Ambassadors, comprising a total of 10 members, including themselves. They received a set of guidelines via email from the TPS team, outlining specific criteria for selecting team members. This orientation session was held mainly focusing on team building and clarifying the guidelines.

This session provided an opportunity for Lead Ambassadors to ask questions and gain a deeper understanding of the selection process of General of the selection process of General Ambassadors. The

formation of these teams was a critical step in our TPS Ambassadorship Program, as the success of our mission to promote mental health awareness and suicide prevention across Pakistan relied on their effectiveness.

V. Incentives

Multiple incentives were announced by the Project Lead to the Ambassadors regarding the Ambassadorship Program in which they have participated. The incentives included were Free Online Trainings, International Recognition, Trip/Gathering, Certifications and Shields.

VI. QnA Session

Ambassadors had many queries about TPS Ambassadorship Program which were carefully answered by the Core Team.

3.2. Proposal Guidelines

3.2.1. Importance of Training

Phase III, the Ambassadorship program of The Project Suicide aimed at creating a network of students all over Pakistan to maximize the reach and impact of the mental health awareness and suicide prevention. Students were recruited as Lead ambassadors and these lead ambassadors in turn recruited general ambassadors to create their own team. These students belonged to different disciplines and mental health and suicide being extremely sensitive topics, required these students to be equipped with skills and knowledge to navigate effectively.

Thus, a comprehensive training program was designed to equip them with knowledge to understand, address and support individuals dealing with mental health issues and suicidal ideation. In this way, if they came across a person with severe mental health issues and suicidal ideation, they would be able to offer empathetic and informed assistance. Moreover, with the help of the training, ambassadors were equipped with the basic knowledge of recognizing the victims of mental health and suicidality crisis.

These teams not only had to deal with people with mental health issues, but they were also assigned different positions that helped in polishing their skills in teamwork, come up with creative ideas and carry out different projects in their respective universities. Therefore, this program encompassed modules on brainstorming activities, psychoeducation, leadership and project management.

The sensitivity of mental health and suicide necessitated a thorough training program for the ambassadors. This training aimed to equip them with the knowledge and skills required to handle these complex situations effectively.

3.2.2. Objectives Of the Training

The comprehensive training program was designed with several objectives in mind:

01

PSYCHOEDUCATION

Psychoeducation provided ambassadors with a deep understanding of mental health issues, their general symptoms, and effective coping mechanisms. This knowledge enabled them to offer informed support and create safe, non-judgmental environments for individuals to discuss their mental health concerns. The training also focused on reducing stigma through scientific explanations and open dialogue, fostering a more accepting and supportive community.

02

LEADERSHIP

Leadership training aimed to harness the power of youth to drive societal change. Ambassadors were encouraged to focus on self-development, acquire knowledge and expertise, and create supportive environments. They were trained to educate, train, and motivate others, fostering a culture of social responsibility and advocacy for mental health awareness. This prepared them to take on leadership roles within their universities and communities, promoting broader societal change.

03

TEAMWORK

The training sessions significantly contributed to understanding teamwork by highlighting the importance of teamwork and challenges that can affect the team's efforts/performance. The sessions underscored the importance of clear roles and responsibilities, effective communication, coordination, problem-solving, creative thinking, and continuous improvement.

04

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Effective project management was crucial for sustaining the program's impact. Ambassadors were trained to build strong, supportive teams, manage resources efficiently, and execute impactful projects. They learned to develop clear plans, timelines, and measurable goals, ensuring that their initiatives were well-organized and sustainable. This training equipped them with the skills to handle challenges, build trust within their communities, and achieve significant, lasting impact in mental health awareness and suicide prevention.

3.2.3. Psychoeducation

Psychoeducation was a central component of the training, providing a structured approach to understanding and addressing mental health issues through three key areas: problem, identification, and solution.

3.1.1.1. Problem

Understanding the problem is the first step towards solving the problem to address it on a grass-root level. What is the problem? Why does it exist? What is the severity of the problem? What is causing the problem? These were some of the questions among many others that were necessary to understand the problem at hand. The training aimed at answering such questions and addressing the stigma surrounding suicide, the language used, and the socio-economic implications.

- **Socio-economic Factors:**

The training explored the socio-economic implications of suicide. The suicide-poverty cycle, where a suicide exacerbates family, The training explored the socio-economic implications of suicide. The suicide-poverty cycle, where suicide exacerbates family poverty and can lead to more suicides, was highlighted. When a person dies by suicide, his/her family suffers as they go below the poverty line and it leads to more deaths by suicide, making the problem even bigger.

- **Risk Factors:**

Factors like self-esteem issues, educational pressures, communication gaps between parents and children, and religious extremism were also discussed.

- **Other Risk Factors:**

Ambassadors were educated on various risk factors for suicide, including self-esteem issues, educational pressures, communication gaps between children and their elders, relationship issues, and religious extremism. This knowledge helped them identify individuals at risk and provide appropriate support.

3.1.1.2. Identification

Accurate identification of a problem is like solving half of the problem, so it helps you go in the right direction. Therefore, accurately identifying red flags is essential for effective intervention.

Understanding the problem and its history in your region would be the first step in identifying the problem. The Ambassadors were also trained to recognize signs of suicidal ideation, such as changes in speech, feelings, and behavior. Warning signs include talking about death or suicide, expressing feelings of hopelessness or being a burden, sudden mood changes, isolation, anger issues, impulsive behavior, and risky actions like substance abuse.

- **Talking**

Individuals contemplating suicide might talk about death, joke about suicide, or express feelings of hopelessness. Phrases like "Life is meaningless," "I'm a burden," or "I hope I don't get up tomorrow", etc. were identified as red flags.

- **Feeling**

Feelings of being burdened and isolated or experiencing sudden shifts between happy and sad states can indicate suicidal thoughts.

- **Behavior**

Changes in behavior such as increased silence, being happy after being sad for a long period of time, anger issues, impulsivity, risky behavior, or changes in sleeping and eating patterns were highlighted as significant warning signs.

3.1.1.3. Prevention & Solution

Prevention strategies focused on creating a safe, non-judgmental environment for open dialogue. Discussing mental health issues openly helps to address and eradicate stigmas and encourages individuals to seek help. Ambassadors were trained to engage empathetically, provide scientific explanations for psychological disorders, and promote mental health awareness.

- **Creating a Safe Environment**

The training emphasized the importance of creating an environment where individuals feel safe discussing their mental health issues without fear of judgment. For example, one ambassador shared their experience of setting up a "listening booth" in their university where students could talk about their issues anonymously and feel heard without judgment.

- **Inclusive Conversations**

Ambassadors were trained to engage with individuals who might initially disagree, including elders (teachers, HODs, etc.) to foster a broader understanding and acceptance of mental health issues. The key is to make them understand your point

instead of challenging them. This could be done by discussing with people to bridge the gap between different generations, enabling a mutual understanding and reducing resistance to mental health initiatives.

- **Measurable Solutions**

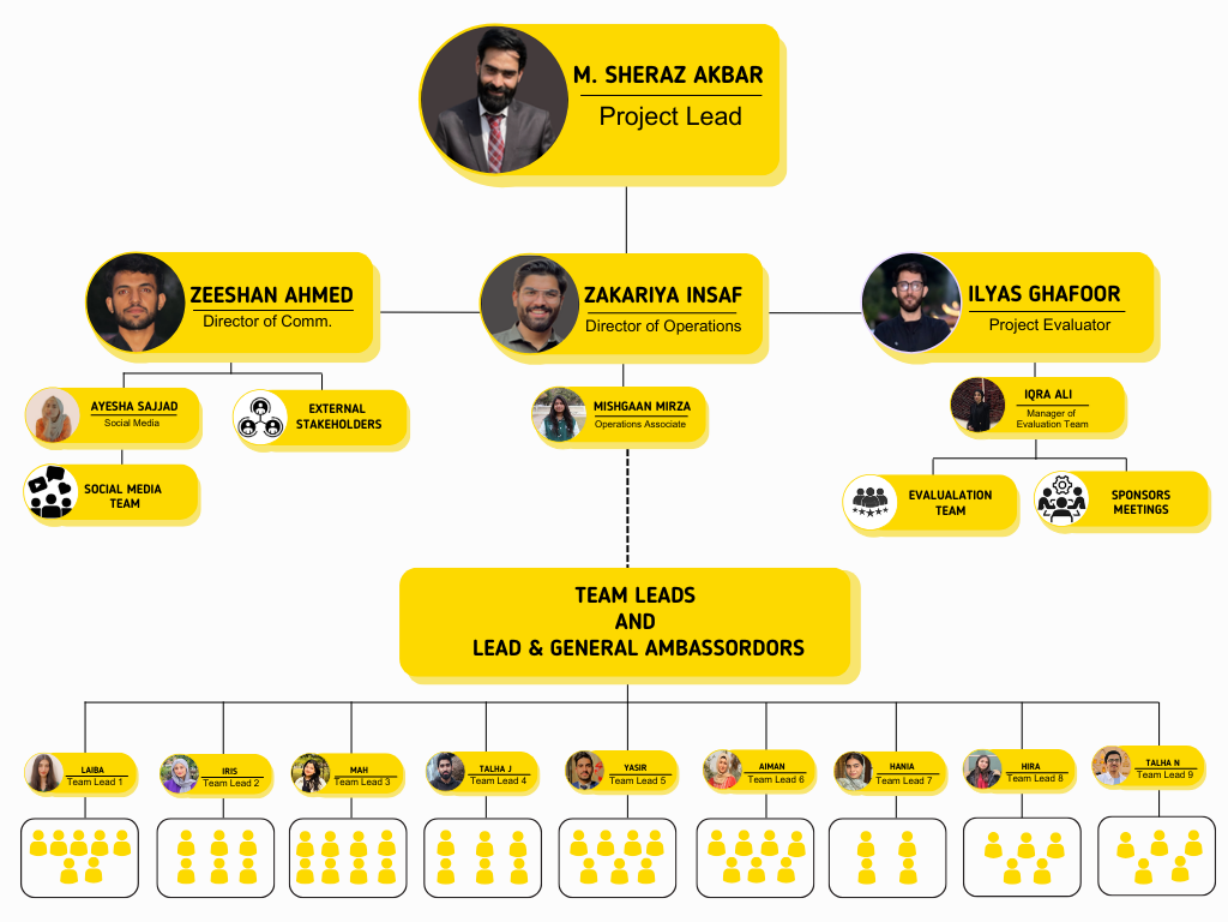
Solutions were designed to be measurable, such as setting specific targets for awareness campaigns within the universities, to ensure tangible outcomes. For example, saying, "I will make 200 students in my university aware of mental health problems" is more tangible than saying, "I will spread awareness in my university, thereby promoting emotional well-being within the university community.

The activity aimed to nurture a culture of openness and gratitude, emphasizing the importance of acknowledging and valuing one's own emotions and experiences.

04. Ambassadorship Program Hierarchy & Roles

4.1. Hierarchy & Roles

The Ambassadorship Program operates through a structured hierarchy led by the Core Team, consisting of four members overseeing various departments. Leadership roles include the Project Lead, Directors, and Team Leads, ensuring effective communication and coordination. The program includes nine Team Leads, such as Laiba Tariq and Talha Noor, each managing 6-8 Lead Ambassadors. In turn, the 56 Lead Ambassadors supervise teams of 9 General Ambassadors responsible for organizing university activities. The Team Leads report to the Operations Director, Zakaria Insaf, who, along with Directors Zeeshan Ahmed and Ilyas Ghafoor, reports to M. Sheraz Akbar, the Project Lead. In exceptional cases, Team Leads may escalate issues directly to the directors, maintaining smooth operations and oversight across Pakistan.



4.1.1. Core Team

The Core Team of the Ambassadorship Program included the top 4 executives of The Project Suicide, each overseeing various departments for the smooth execution of the program.

Mohammad Sheraz Akbar, founder of The Project Suicide holds the highest position on the organizational chart. Serving as the Project Lead, he oversees all operations. All updates, and reports are ultimately directed to him, following a structured communication flow.
Below M. Sheraz Akbar, there are three directors:

- Ilyas Ghafoor serves as the Project Evaluator.
- Zeeshan Ahmed holds the role of Director of Communications.
- Zakaria Insaf assumes the position of Director of Operations.

MOHAMMAD SHERAZ AKBAR
(Project Lead)

Co-founder of The Project Suicide, Ilyas Ghafoor serves as the Project Evaluator for the program.

As the Project Evaluator, Ilyas is responsible for reviewing all proposed activities submitted by our ambassador's team across various universities. Activity proposals are initially received by Team Leads, who then forward them to Ilyas for evaluation and approval. Furthermore, he is also responsible for meetings with sponsors.

ILYAS GHAFOOR
(Project Evaluator)

As the Director of Communications, Zeeshan Ahmed oversees all communication-related activities. His primary responsibilities involve engaging with external stakeholders and managing collaborations. Additionally, he supervises the Social Media Team Lead, who is responsible for providing updates and managing posts on TPS social media platforms, including LinkedIn, Instagram, and Facebook. He also oversees the design management of all TPS-related graphics, including cards, shields, & certificates, etc.

ZEESHAN AHMED
(Director of Communications)

Zakaria Insaf serves as the Operations Director of the program. He is responsible for overseeing all the operations of the program.

For that holds weekly meetings with Team Leads to discuss updates and challenges. The nine Team Leads—Laiba Tariq, Iris Liaqat, Mah Ali Khan, Talha Jalal, Muhammad Yasir Usman, Aiman Mukhtar, Hania Javed, Hira Shehzadi, and Talha Noor—manage 56 Lead Ambassadors, each overseeing 6 to 8 Lead Ambassadors who represent universities across Pakistan.

ZAKARIA INSAF
(Director of Operations)

4.1.2. Associates

Each Director from the Core Team—Ilyas Ghafoor, Zeeshan Ahmed, and Zakaria Insaf, has an Associate who assists them with their tasks and is directly trained as a potential replacement for future phases of the program.

Iqra Ali, a psychology graduate, contributed as Associate - Project Evaluator for the program.

The primary responsibility was compiling a comprehensive report that analyzed and assessed data from activities conducted across various universities in Pakistan during the Ambassadorship program.

IQRA ALI
(Associate – Project Evaluator)

Talha Noor, a software engineer, served as the Associate - Director of Communications for the program.

He assisted the Director of Communications with managing emails and the official TPS WhatsApp number. Additionally, he identified communication flow gaps for the current phase and developed a robust communication platform on Discord for future phases.

TALHA NOOR
(Associate – Director of Communications)

Mishgaan Mirza served as the Associate - Director of Operations for the program.

She worked alongside the Director of Operations to manage all team leads and effectively resolve critical issues. Additionally, she hosted weekly meetings to prioritize tasks, track progress, and maintain team morale.

MISHGAAN MIRZA
(Associate – Project Evaluator)

4.1.3. Team Leads

The final role in the hierarchy of the internal team for The Ambassadorship Program (AP) was for Team Leads. There were nine Team Leads for AP universities and one Team Lead in the internal team of The Project Suicide. The details for each are provided below:

AYESHA SAJJAD

Ayesha Sajjad, a Mass Communication student, serves as the Team Lead for the Social Media Team at The Project Suicide. In her role, she manages a team of video editors, graphic designers, and content writers. Ayesha is responsible for assigning and overseeing content generated by various university teams, each led by a lead ambassador.

She collects content from the team leads participating in the Ambassadorship Program and delegates this material to her team for creating reels, posts, and stories. Additionally, she oversees the organization's social media accounts, which includes posting, scheduling, sharing stories, and managing direct messages to ensure everything operates smoothly.

LAIBA TARIQ

The **Initial Universities** under her supervision included:

- Bahauddin Zakariya University, Multan
- Agriculture University, Peshawar
- National College of Arts, Lahore
- Virtual University, Jaranwala
- Riphah University, Faisalabad
- National College of Business Administration & Economics, Lahore
- Khyber Medical College

The **Final Universities** under the Team Lead's guidance at the end of the program were:

- University of Agriculture, Peshawar
- Bahauddin Zakariya University, Multan

Laiba Tariq, a graduate of Bachelor's in Psychology from COMSATS University Islamabad, has been volunteering with The Project Suicide for nearly 1.5 years. Currently, she serves as a Team Lead in the Ambassadorship Program.

IRIS LIAQAT

The **Initial Universities** under her supervision included:

- Bahauddin Hamdard University Islamabad
- Shifa University Chak Shehzad campus
- HITECH
- Fazaia Bilquis College of Education for Women PAF College Nur Khan Air Base, Rwp
- University of Azad Jammu and Kashmir
- University of Swabi

The **Final Universities** under her at the end of the program were:

- University of Swabi
- Fazaia Bilquis College of Education for Women PAF Nur Khan Rawalpindi
- University of Azad Jammu and Kashmir

Iris Liaqat, Psychology Undergrad from COMSATS University Islamabad holds the title of being the first female volunteer in The Project Suicide. Currently, she serves as a Team Lead in the Ambassadorship Program.

HANIA JAVED

The **Initial Universities** under her supervision included:

- National Defense University, Islamabad
- Aziz Fatima Medical and Dental College, Faisalabad
- Bahria Islamabad
- University of Health Sciences

The **Final Universities** under her supervision at the end of the program were:

- Aziz Fatima Medical and Dental College, Faisalabad.
- National Defense University, Islamabad

Hania Javed, currently in her final year of BS Psychology in COMSATS University Islamabad. She has been involved with The Project Suicide as a volunteer for a year and is now serving as Team Lead.

HAFIZ TALHA JALAL

The **Initial Universities** under his supervision included:

- International Islamic University Islamabad
- Karakoram international university Ghizer campus
- University Of Lahore
- University of Baltistan, Katapna
- Allama Iqbal Open University, Skardu
- Bolan University Quetta
- Riphah International University Islamabad

The **Final Universities** under him at the end of the program were:

- International Islamic University, Girls Campus Islamabad
- International Islamic University, Boys Campus Islamabad
- Karakoram international university Ghizer campus
- University of Lahore

Hafiz Talha Jalal, the graduate of Bachelor's in Biosciences from COMSATS University Islamabad, has been working as a volunteer in TPS from almost 1.5 years. He currently serves as Team Lead in TPS Ambassadorship Program.

HIRA SHEHZADI

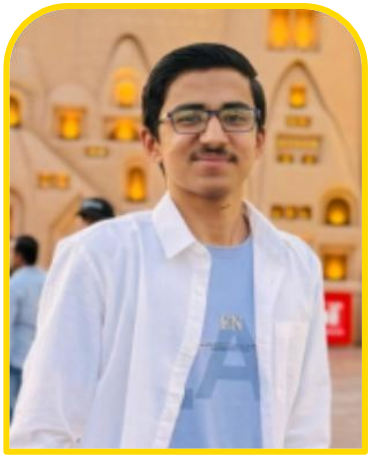
The **Initial Universities** under her supervision included:

- National University of Modern Languages (NUML)
- Government College University Faisalabad (GCUF)
- Federal Urdu University of Arts Science and Technology, Islamabad
- Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University
- Hazrat Bari Sarkar (HBS) Medical and Dental College
- COMSATS University, Abbottabad

The **Final Universities** under her at the end of the program were:

- Government College University Faisalabad (GCUF)
- National University of Modern Languages (NUML)
- COMSATS University, Abbottabad
- Federal Urdu University of Arts Science and Technology, Islamabad
- Khyber Medical University, Islamabad

Hira Shehzadi, a recent graduate of BS Biosciences from COMSATS University Islamabad, has been volunteering with, The Project Suicide for a year. Currently, she serves as a Team Lead in the TPS Ambassadorship Program.



TALHA NOOR

The **Initial Universities** under his supervision included:

- National Bahria University Karachi
- Dow UHS Karachi
- GIKI, Topi, Swabi
- University of Engineering & Technology (UET), Lahore

The **Final Universities** under his supervision at the end of the program were:

- Government University of Baltistan, Hasan Abad
- Bahria University, Karachi
- GIKI Topi, Swabi
- Riphah University, Islamabad

Talha Noor, an undergraduate student of BS Software Engineering from Riphah University Islamabad, has been volunteering with The Project Suicide for a year. Currently, he holds the position of Team Lead in the TPS Ambassadorship Program.

MAH ALI KHAN

The **Initial Universities** under her supervision included:

- Liaqat National Medical college, Karachi
- National University of Sciences and Technology (NUST), Isb.
- Quaid e Azam University, Islamabad
- Health Services Academy, Islamabad
- Gomal University, Dera Ismail Khan
- Jahanzeb College, Swat
- University of Baltistan, Sundas Campus, Skardu
- University of Baltistan, Anchan Campus, Skardu

The **Final Universities** under her supervision at the end of the program were:

- National University of Sciences and Technology (NUST), Isb.
- Quaid e Azam University, Islamabad
- Health Services Academy, Islamabad
- Gomal University, Dera Ismail Khan
- Jahanzeb College, Swat
- University of Baltistan, Sundas Campus, Skardu
- University of Baltistan, Anchan Campus, Skardu

Mah Ali Khan, currently pursuing Bachelor's in Biosciences from COMSATS University Islamabad, has been associated with The Project Suicide for a year. In ongoing TPS Ambassadorship Program, she holds the position of Team Lead.

M. YASIR USMAN

The **Initial Universities** under his supervision included:

- University of Peshawar
- Comsats University Islamabad
- City university of Science and Technology Peshawar
- CECOS University Peshawar
- Bacha Khan University Charsadda
- Abdul Wali Khan University Mardan
- University of Punjab, Lahore

The **Final Universities** under his supervision at the end of the program were:

- University of Peshawar
- Comsats University Islamabad
- City University of Science and Technology Peshawar
- CECOS University Peshawar
- Bacha Khan University Charsadda
- Abdul Wali Khan University Mardan
- University of Punjab, Lahore

Muhammad Yasir Usman, an undergraduate student of BS Psychology from the University of Swabi, has been involved with The Project Suicide since its beginning and has the honor of being among the first few volunteers who joined TPS. Currently, he holds the role of Team Lead in TPS Ambassadorship Program.

AIMAN MUKHTAR

The **Initial Universities** under her supervision included:

- Islamic International Dental College, Islamabad
- Karakoram International University, Gilgit campus
- Karakoram International University, Hunza campus
- SZABIST, Islamabad
- University of Baluchistan, Quetta
- University of Kotli, Azad Kashmir
- Jinnah Sindh Medical University, Karachi

The **Final Universities** under her supervision at the end of the program were:

- Islamic International Dental College, Islamabad
- Karakoram International University, Gilgit campus
- Karakoram International University, Hunza campus
- University of Kotli, Azad Kashmir
- Jinnah Sindh Medical University, Karachi

Aiman Mukhtar, graduate of BS in Psychology from COMSATS University Islamabad, has been playing a role of volunteer and associated with The Project Suicide from past 1.5 years. Currently, she holds the position of Team Lead in TPS Ambassadorship Program.

05. Execution

5.1. Execution

The execution phase of the Ambassadorship Program was pivotal in translating training into impactful, on-ground activities. Ambassadors, armed with comprehensive knowledge and skills acquired before and during the execution phase via training sessions, implemented a variety of initiatives within their respective universities. These training sessions covered a wide range of topics, such as project planning, psychoeducation, psychological first aid, and leadership skills. This thorough preparation enabled ambassadors to design and execute initiatives tailored to the specific needs of their university communities.

These activities were meticulously designed not only to raise awareness about mental health and suicide prevention but also to create a supportive and stigma free environment where individuals felt safe discussing their struggles and seeking help. By fostering open conversations and promoting a culture of empathy and understanding, the ambassadors helped break down long-standing stigmas and encouraged proactive help- seeking behavior.

Ambassadors followed a structured approach that included detailed proposals and thorough planning to ensure that each activity was meaningful, engaging, and effective in addressing the sensitive issues of mental health and suicide. This phase was crucial in putting theoretical knowledge into practice, demonstrating the program's commitment to making a tangible difference in the mental health landscape of their communities.

5.1.1. Brainstorming

The teams were encouraged to generate innovative ideas for activities focused on mental health awareness and suicide prevention. To facilitate this, a training session was held to address the queries of Lead Ambassadors and General Ambassadors. During this session, examples were provided to ensure a clear understanding of how to effectively brainstorm activities. Ambassadors were encouraged to think creatively and develop unique initiatives tailored to their communities. This approach ensured that the initiatives were not only relevant but also innovative, empowering ambassadors to tackle mental health issues in a way that resonated with their peers.

Ambassadors were guided to design activities requiring minimal resources while achieving maximum impact. They were encouraged to focus on initiatives that would resonate with

and be easily understood by the people in their specific communities. This guidance helped ensure that the activities would successfully convey the desired message and engage the target audience effectively. Ambassadors were guided to design activities requiring minimal resources while achieving maximum impact. They were encouraged to focus on initiatives that would resonate with and be easily understood by the people in their specific communities. This guidance helped ensure that the activities would successfully convey the desired message and engage the target audience effectively.

5.1.2. Activity Proposal

Ambassadors were provided with a structured template for activity proposals and received comprehensive training on how to complete it effectively. The core team explained each section of the template, highlighting the essential points that needed to be included. This training ensured that ambassadors understood the critical components of a well-constructed activity proposal.

Furthermore, the process of submitting and approving Activity Proposals was a structured approach aimed at empowering ambassadors and ensuring the success of their planned activities. By guiding ambassadors through this process, the program ensured they understood expectations and were prepared to navigate challenges effectively. This preparation was crucial for ambassadors to execute their initiative confidently. Moreover, the process upheld a high standard of quality and effectiveness across all proposed activities. Each proposal had to closely align with the program's objectives, guaranteeing that every initiative had a clear purpose and the potential to make a significant impact. This systematic approach not only streamlined decision-making but also ensured that the program focused its efforts on achieving goals with purpose and efficacy.

A template of the activity proposal can be found **HERE**.

5.2. Guidelines for Activity Proposal

Various activities were meticulously designed by university teams with the primary goal of raising awareness about mental health and suicide prevention while normalizing discussions on these sensitive topics. These activities were tailored to the diverse needs of their communities, considering available resources to ensure that the message of mental health and suicide prevention was clear and accessible to everyone. The aim was to create a lasting impact on suicide prevention within their respective communities.

One notable example, as given in the Activity Proposal template above, the ***"Ripple Effect by The Project Suicide"*** initiative implemented by Team NUST, involved the creation and distribution of around a thousand cards to random students and faculty members. These cards featured hopeful quotations designed to uplift spirits and instill a sense of hope. The anonymous distribution of these cards helped recipients feel acknowledged and supported, reinforcing the message that help is always available and that they are not alone in their struggles. This initiative was conducted in many universities across Pakistan, directly impacting thousands of individuals. It effectively created awareness about mental health and suicide prevention while fostering a supportive environment within the communities. By anonymously sharing messages of hope, the initiative aimed to break the stigma surrounding mental health issues and suicide prevention, and encouraged open conversations, ultimately contributing to a more compassionate and understanding community. Ambassadors were required to submit detailed Activity Proposals before executing any activity. However, some university teams, particularly those from regions with educational constraints such as the northern areas, Baluchistan, and southern Punjab, were given leniency regarding these proposals. These teams were allowed to fill out only certain sections of the Activity Proposal to ease their burden.

5.2.1. Contents of Activity Proposal

The Activity Proposals included several critical sections:

I. University Details

This section included the name of the University submitting the activity proposal, and the name and contact number of the Lead Ambassador.

II. Activity Details

This section required a comprehensive description of the planned activity, including its name and specific details explaining it. For example, “Ripple Effect by The Project Suicide” would be

detailed as an activity where "vibe uplift cards" with hopeful quotations were anonymously distributed among students to appreciate and acknowledge their silent struggles. This section aimed to ensure clarity, and an understanding of the activity and to make sure that the proposed activities were aligned with the goals of promoting mental health awareness and suicide prevention within university communities.

III. Objectives & Deliverables

Ambassadors were required to clearly define the objectives and expected outcomes of their activities. For example, the objectives of the "Ripple effect by The Project Suicide" included fostering hope, support, and outreach among anonymous individuals to create a compassionate and supportive environment. The deliverables included designing cards, creating a strategic distribution plan, and personally distributing them to individuals. aligned with the goals of promoting mental health awareness and suicide prevention within university communities.

IV. Stakeholders

This section identified all individuals and groups affected by the activity. For the “Ripple effect by The Project Suicide” stakeholders would include the TPS AP NUST Team members, students to whom cards are distributed, and university administration.

V. Feasibility Analysis

Ambassadors conducted a comprehensive feasibility analysis to assess the costs, resources, and time needed for the activity. For instance, in the above-mentioned activity. This included estimating the printing costs for the cards, gathering participant feedback, and coordinating team members to assemble simultaneously at a specified location to execute the activity.

VI. Risk Management

Identifying potential risks and devising strategies to mitigate them was crucial. Challenges included low engagement from students and faculty due to stigma around mental health and suicide, potential miscommunication between Lead and General Ambassadors, and difficulties in coordinating simultaneous gatherings of team members for activities.

Time constraints for collecting participant feedback also posed a risk. Teams proactively managed these risks to ensure the smooth execution of activities, implementing strategies such as clear communication plans, contingency scheduling, and proactive engagement strategies to mitigate potential issues.

VII. Success Evaluation

Ambassadors were given a methodology to assess the success of their activities through a comprehensive Success Evaluation framework. This framework included four key points: Direct and Indirect Impact, Number of People referred to get psychological help, number of stigmas broken, and number of lives saved. For instance, in the "Ripple effect by The Project Suicide" initiative, the direct impact could be quantified by the number of cards distributed and the feedback received from participants, which indicated the level of engagement. Indirect impact was measured by tracking the number of individuals who inquired about the activity but declined to take cards, reflecting interest and awareness generated despite not directly participating. This evaluation approach provided insights into both immediate outcomes and broader societal impacts of the initiatives undertaken by the ambassadors.

5.2.2. Things to Look Out for in the Proposal

Ambassadors were instructed to pay close attention to several key elements when preparing their proposals:

I. Speakers Qualification for Seminars

It was crucial to select speakers who were qualified and knowledgeable in mental health and suicide prevention topics to ensure credibility and effective communication.

II. Avoidance of Triggering Content/Activities

Ambassadors were advised to avoid content or activities that could potentially trigger distress or discomfort among participants, maintaining a safe and supportive environment.

III. Cultural Appropriateness

Activities needed to be culturally sensitive and respectful of the values and norms of the university community, ensuring inclusiveness and relevance.

IV. Age Restrictions for Suicide Discussion

Discussions related to suicide were restricted to individuals above the age of 18, considering their maturity level and the sensitivity of the topic.

Following the established communication flow, the Lead Ambassador and their team were responsible for filling out the proposal document. Once done, the document is sent to the respective Team Lead which is then forwarded to the Project Evaluation Team, which scrutinized each proposal based on criteria such as cost, feasibility,

time constraints, and sensitivity to ensure alignment with program objectives. The evaluation team assessed each proposal, either approving or rejecting proposed activities and providing feedback or suggesting necessary changes in the proposal. After the proposals were reviewed and endorsed, they were authorized to carry out their planned activities within their universities. This approval process was crucial to guarantee that the activities were carefully planned, practical to implement, and aligned with the Ambassadorship Program's goals of enhancing mental health awareness and advocating for suicide prevention ensuring that all initiatives were well-considered and likely to achieve their intended impacts in their respective communities.

5.2.3. Execution of Activities by University teams across Pakistan

The execution phase witnessed university teams across Pakistan conducting a diverse array of impactful initiatives, with a remarkable total of 80 activities dedicated to mental health awareness and suicide prevention throughout the Ambassadorship Program. Each team planned and implemented their activities, ensuring they were impactful and relevant to their local communities.

The ambassadors demonstrated exceptional commitment by tailoring their initiatives to address the unique needs and challenges of their respective universities. They engaged in extensive research and brainstorming sessions to develop activities that would effectively resonate with their peers. Despite varying resources and constraints, the teams showed remarkable creativity and resourcefulness in executing their plans. Throughout this phase, the teams worked tirelessly to foster a supportive environment and encourage open discussions about mental health. They collaborated closely, coordinated schedules, and managed logistics ensuring the smooth execution of their activities. The dedication of the ambassadors was evident in the thorough preparation, detailed planning, and enthusiastic participation observed during the activities.

In addition to the practical aspects of organizing these events, the ambassadors also faced the challenge of addressing sensitive topics with empathy and sensitivity. They navigated these challenges with professionalism and compassion, creating safe spaces for students to share their experiences and seek support. Their efforts contributed significantly to raising awareness, reducing stigma, and promoting

proactive help-seeking behavior on their campuses.

Through this impressive array of 80 activities carried out by various university teams, our ambassadors managed to directly and indirectly impact thousands of individuals. Below are some examples of the activities:

5.2.3.1. National University of Science and Technology, Islamabad (NUST)

Thrive Talks: Project Suicide Insights into Mental Health:

Thrive Talks: Project Suicide Insights into Mental Health" with Dr. Zainab Khan was an interactive session aimed at enhancing community understanding and fostering dialogue about mental health. Hosted by The Project Suicide and led by esteemed psychologist Dr. Zainab Khan, this event offered participants valuable insights into maintaining mental wellness and practical strategies for daily mental health care. Through a blend of expert lectures and engaging Q&A sessions, the event created an informative and supportive environment for students, faculty, and community members, reinforcing commitment to mental health education and stigma reduction.

Dr. Zainab engaged the participants in

an interactive and meaningful activity where they made a group of two individuals who shared their struggles and life stories with one another to foster an environment where open dialogue and communication about sensitive topics of mental health and suicide were made possible.

Lastly, sticky notes were given to the audience to write down their feedback about the session. For Dr. Zainab's outstanding contribution, she was honored with an appreciation shield by The Project Suicide - Ambassadorship Program's NUST Team.

5.2.3.2. National University of Modern Languages (NUML)

An Unsent Postcard:

Participants were provided with printed postcards containing prompts such as “To the one who is about to give up,” “I wish I could tell my past self,” “To my future self,” and “My greatest dream/fear is.” They were invited to write short letters in response to these prompts, allowing them to express thoughts and feelings they might not otherwise share openly. Additionally, there was space for participants to visually represent their emotions through drawing or coloring. This activity served as a creative and reflective outlet, offering a means to articulate unspoken emotions and engage in self-expression in a supportive environment.

5.2.3.3. Quaid-e-Azam University, Islamabad (QAU)

The Suicide Prevention Booth:

An awareness and helping booth strategically placed near the central library of Quaid e Azam University in Islamabad served as a pivotal initiative by the team to address the sensitive issue of suicide in their university community. This booth provided a platform for discussions on the root causes, risk factors, and preventive measures related to suicide

Alongside this initiative, an engaging activity titled "Today, Your Emotions" was conducted. Participants were invited to associate different emotions with specific colors, such as pink for hope and orange for anger. They used sticky notes of corresponding colors to visually express their emotions, creating an interactive and expressive atmosphere. During the activity, some individuals bravely shared personal stories about their struggles with

mental health challenges and thoughts of suicide. This open sharing helped break down societal taboos and encouraged others to join the conversation. Informational pamphlets were also put down in the booth, providing insights into local suicide statistics and discussing the underlying causes of suicidal tendencies. participants were encouraged to provide feedback on how these activities impacted them and whether they found the event uplifting and hopeful. This comprehensive approach aimed not only to raise awareness but also to create a supportive environment where discussing and addressing mental health issues was encouraged and supported within the university community.

5.2.3.4. Government College University, Faisalabad (GCU)

Discover peace Through The Gratitude Box:

In this activity, students were encouraged to reflect on and express gratitude for meaningful moments in their lives. They were prompted to write about personal feelings, experiences, or challenges they may not have openly shared before.

By inviting students to share moments they were thankful for and to delve into their personal experiences, the activity provided an opportunity for self-reflection and emotional expression. This process was intended to support students in finding peace and understanding through introspection,

06. Ambassadorship Program-I Final Evaluation

6.1. Final Program Evaluation:

Upon completion of the activities by the ambassadors in their universities, it was time to evaluate these activities in an objective way to determine and conclude which university performed the best. This evaluation process was essential to recognizing and rewarding outstanding efforts, as well as identifying areas for improvement. By objectively assessing the performance of each university team, we aimed to ensure that the goals of the Ambassadorship Program were met effectively and to set a standard for future initiatives.

6.1.1. Grassroot Evaluation:

To evaluate the impact at grassroot level we must evaluate each individual activity conducted by each university. This part will cover the evaluation criteria that were set for calculating the impact of each activity and each university.

6.1.1.1. General Evaluation Parameters:

To decide this, we established a set of criteria that reflected the program's objectives. These criteria included various measurable variables that could provide a comprehensive assessment of each university's efforts and impact. We then calculated these variables to see which university targeted them and to what extent. This detailed evaluation allowed us to understand the scope and effectiveness of each team's activities.

The following are the parameters that we considered during evaluation of each activity:

I. Indirect Impact (I)

This variable measures the number of individuals who actively participated in activities conducted by our ambassadors at their respective universities. It reflects the direct reach and immediate impact of our mental health and suicide awareness initiatives on the participants.

II. Direct Impact (DI)

This variable measures the number of individuals who actively participated in activities conducted by our ambassadors at their respective universities. It reflects the direct reach and immediate impact of our mental health and suicide awareness initiatives on the participants.

III. Stigma Broken (S)

This variable counts the number of individuals who, during activities and seminars, found the courage to share their personal stories or struggles with mental health issues. By doing so, they helped to break cultural and societal stigmas surrounding mental health. This measure indicates the extent to which our initiatives encouraged open dialogue and reduced stigma.

IV. Referrals (R)

This variable tracks the number of individuals who sought psychological help from our ambassadors and were referred to The Project Suicide. Subsequently, these individuals related to psychological professionals by our team or certified psychologists who were involved in the seminars. This metric shows the effectiveness of our referral system in providing professional mental health support.

V. Collaborations (C)

This variable measures the number of partnerships formed by our ambassador teams with different institutions or organizations for conducting activities related to mental health and suicide prevention at their universities. This metric indicates the extent of collaborative efforts and resource sharing to enhance the impact of our initiatives.

VI. Hope Given(H)

Also referred to as *"Lives Save",* this variable represents the number of individuals whose lives were potentially saved through the intervention of our ambassadors during the Ambassadorship Program-Cycle I. This variable was meticulously verified by The Core Team to ensure its accuracy.

These variables collectively provided a comprehensive framework for evaluating the effectiveness and reach of our ambassadors' efforts in promoting mental health awareness and suicide prevention in their respective institutions.

6.1.1.2. Weightage of Each Parameter:

During the execution of activities, our ambassadors were equipped with a detailed document provided by The Project Suicide. This document was meticulously designed to ensure the accurate and efficient calculation of all specified variables. Ambassadors were also required to provide comprehensive descriptions of how each variable was targeted during their activities, ensuring the accuracy and authenticity of the collected data. This means that for each activity, ambassadors had to explain the methods they used to measure direct and indirect impact, stigma broken,

referrals, lives saved, and collaborations. This thorough approach was crucial in maintaining the integrity of the data and ensuring that the reported outcomes truly reflected the efforts made.

It means that each university reported the cumulative values for all the activities conducted, providing a clear picture of the overall reach and effectiveness. These cumulative values help us understand the broad scope of influence our ambassadors had, ranging from the number of individuals directly and indirectly impacted to the partnerships formed and lives potentially saved.

So, the Raw Values calculated so far for the total impact of Ambassadorship Program (Cycle-I) are

Evaluation Parameters	***Values Achieved***
Indirect Impact (I)	4842
Direct Impact (D)	8192
Stigmas Broken (S)	230
Referrals (R)	114
Collaborations (C)	18
Hopes Given (H)	2

6.1.1.3. Weightage of Each Parameter:

Each of the above-mentioned parameter variables were assigned different weightages based on their complexity, importance, and overall impact. For instance, the variable Referrals (R) is considered more complex and challenging to achieve compared to Direct Impact (DI) or Indirect Impact (ID). Consequently, Referrals are given a higher value to reflect its greater difficulty and significance. To accurately quantify the impact of each variable, we devised an equation that ensures each value corresponds appropriately to its respective impact. This equation takes into account the varying levels of effort and significance associated with each variable, providing a more balanced and fair evaluation of the activities conducted by our ambassadors.

The **Final TPS Equation** devised for the program was:

$$E = I + 2(D + 2S + 3R + 5C) + 50H$$

The following is given the weightage and rationale of assigning specific values to all the significant values:

I. Stigma Broken (S)

Stigma Broken (S) was assigned a value of 2. This relatively low value acknowledges the significant stigma surrounding mental health and suicide in Pakistani society, making it challenging for individuals to come forward and share their struggles.

II. Referrals (R)

Referrals (R) were given a value of 3, reflecting the rarity and difficulty of people seeking psychological help in Pakistan. Moreover, it should be taken into consideration that in a lot of places in Pakistan there is no availability of psychologist in the city and referring an individual to a professional is indeed a very hard task with all these contingencies.

III. Collaborations (C)

Collaborations (C) were assigned a higher value of 5 due to the complexity of establishing partnerships. These collaborations were facilitated by our ambassadors, who are students, representing The Project Suicide.

Given the limited awareness and acceptance of mental health and suicide prevention in Pakistan, securing partnerships posed a considerable challenge.

IV. Hope Given (H)

Additionally, the variable Hope Given (H) also known as Lives Saved was given a significant value of 50 making in the most impactful variable among all others.

For instance, the impact calculation of Bahaudin Zakaria University using that also resulted in saving one life is as follows:

Evaluation Parameters	***Values Achieved***
Indirect Impact (I)	305
Direct Impact (D)	619
Stigmas Broken (S)	19
Referrals (R)	1
Collaborations (C)	2
Hopes Given (H)	1

Now according to TPS Equation:

$$E = I + 2(D + 2S + 3R + 5C) + 50H$$

Putting all the values

$$E = 305 + 2\,(619 + 2x19 + 3x1 + 5x2) + 50(1)$$

$$E = 305 + 1340 + 50$$

$$E = 1645 + 50$$

$$E = 1695$$

The calculated value **1695** represents the total impact generated by the team of Bahaddin Zakaria University, Multan throughout the program.

6.1.1.4. Evaluation Criteria for Stigmatized Regions:

The equation provided above is the standard method used to assess the impact of our ambassador teams in educational institutions across Pakistan. However, it was primarily tailored for regions or universities where stigma related to mental health and suicide is relatively lower. In contrast, there are regions such as Gilgit Baltistan and Baluchistan where stigma is more pronounced. Through research conducted in Phase I of The Project Suicide, specific universities in rural and remote areas were identified as facing greater challenges in conducting activities due to heightened stigma.

These regions exhibit significantly higher stigma levels compared to major cities like Islamabad and Lahore. For instance, it may be relatively easier for ambassadors from COMSATS University, Islamabad to conduct activities than those from Karakoram International University, Ghizar Campus. To ensure a fair and accurate evaluation in these highly stigmatized areas, a separate equation was devised specifically for assessing the impact of activities conducted in these selected universities.

The **Adjusted TPS Equation** devised for these stigmatized regions was:

$$E = I + 2(D + 4S* + 6R* + 5C) + 50H$$

In this specialized equation, each variable is weighed differently to reflect the specific challenges and cultural dynamics prevalent in stigmatized regions. For example, Stigma Broken (S) carries a weight of 4, underscoring the difficulty and significance of combatting cultural stigma associated with mental health and suicide in these areas. Referrals (R) are assigned a weight of 6, recognizing their crucial role in facilitating access to professional psychological support in regions where such services may be scarce or heavily stigmatized. Conversely, Collaborations (C) maintains the same weight as in the standard equation, at 5, emphasizing the effort required to establish partnerships in areas where awareness and acceptance of mental health issues are limited. Furthermore, the value assigned to Hope Given (H) remains consistent at 50 across all evaluations.

To further clarify this, here's the evaluation of Karakoram International University, Ghizar campus according to specialized equation:

Evaluation Parameters	***Values Achieved***
Indirect Impact (I)	10
Direct Impact (D)	40
Stigmas Broken (S)	5
Referrals (R)	0
Collaborations (C)	0
Hopes Given (H)	0

Now according to TPS Equation:

$$\boldsymbol{E = I + 2(D + 4S + 6R + 5C) + 50H}$$

Putting all the values

$$\boldsymbol{E = 10 + 2\,(40 + 4x5 + 6x0 + 5x0) + 50(0)}$$

$$\boldsymbol{E = 10 + 120 + 0}$$

$$\boldsymbol{E = 130}$$

The calculated value **130** represents the total impact generated by the team of Karakoram International University, Ghizar campus throughout the program.

6.1.2. Overall Impact Evaluation & Comparison

The values obtained from the above evaluation represent the impact created by our ambassadors in their respective universities. These values were calculated using both the standard equation and a specialized equation for stigmatized universities, as needed.

Finally, by summing up all the variables we derive a single value that quantifies the effectiveness and reach of the activities conducted. The earlier explanations illustrate how each variable was weighted and factored into the equation to ensure an accurate assessment of the overall impact. The final values serve as a quantitative measurement of the ambassadors' collective efforts across all activities. Once the final value for each university was determined, we compared these values to evaluate the relative impact each university achieved. This comparison highlights the success and reach of the mental health and suicide prevention initiatives carried out by our ambassadors in various educational institutions.

These final values represent the impact assessments of the 30 most active universities. Currently, calculations from five universities are still pending, so our evaluations are based on the data available from these 30 institutions. Additionally, certain universities operate in a virtual environment, which means their methods of conducting activities differed. For instance, institutions like Allama Iqbal Open University and Virtual University worked online, aligning with their status as virtual and degree-awarding institutions.

6.1.3. Top Ranked Universities Based on Impact Scores

After completing the evaluation of all universities and compiling a ranked list based on their performance, a "University value" has been derived from the cumulative impact scores achieved by each university's ambassador teams. This assessment highlights the pivotal roles played by these universities in initiatives focused on mental health and suicide prevention. Below are the top 6 universities, along with their respective University values, illustrating their significant contributions to these efforts.

Rank	***University Name***	***Overall Impact Score***
1st	National University of Science & Technology, Islamabad	2813
2nd	Bahauddin Zakariya University, Multan	2725
3rd	Comsats University Islamabad	2469
4th	University of Swabi	1654
5th	Quaid e Azam University, Islamabad	1384
6th	National Defense University, Islamabad	1232

However, these values do not diminish the efforts of other universities that may not be listed here. Our society is multifaceted, with diverse dimensions and cultural variations across Pakistan. Every university, regardless of its ranking, has contributed tirelessly within its means and resources. The quantitative measurements provided by these equations offer one perspective on success and evaluation, but they are not the sole criterion. It is important to recognize that universities operated within varying contexts and faced unique challenges.

Hence, these evaluations are just one facet of a broader assessment process. We will also employ additional qualitative and contextual methods to ensure a comprehensive evaluation of each university's efforts. By combining these approaches, we aim to identify and celebrate universities that have excelled in advancing mental health and suicide prevention initiatives, acknowledging the diverse ways in which they contributed to societal well-being.

6.1.4. Evaluation of Team Leads

After evaluating the success of universities in our mental health and suicide prevention initiatives, the next crucial step involved assessing the effectiveness of the Team Leads responsible for overseeing these institutions.

This process included aggregating the impact values from all universities under each Team Lead's supervision. For instance, if a Team Lead supervised 6 universities, the impact values from each university were combined to derive a final evaluation score for that Team Lead. Analyzing these cumulative scores allowed us to measure the level of effort and dedication demonstrated by each Team Lead in managing their universities. A higher cumulative score indicated not only greater dedication, but also more effective coordination

and guidance provided by the Team Lead to their university teams, ensuring that initiatives were executed with diligence and impactful results.

6.1.5. Conclusion

The execution of these activities across diverse university campuses stands as a testament to the unwavering commitment and ingenuity of the ambassadors in championing mental health awareness and suicide prevention. Leveraging their comprehensive training and fostering close collaboration within their teams, they adeptly implemented a wide array of activities that not only captivated their communities but also fostered meaningful dialogue and provided essential support to those grappling with mental health challenges.

These efforts were pivotal in not just challenging societal taboos but also in laying the groundwork for sustained advocacy and compassionate understanding of mental health issues within their academic environments.

Through their proactive initiatives, the ambassadors not only raised awareness but also cultivated a culture of empathy and resilience, ensuring lasting impacts on the mental well-being of the people in their surroundings and beyond.